Claims Handling Standard Operating Procedure

1. Registration

1.1 The claims handler must register every claim in the claims system on the day it is received.

1.2 The claims handler shall verify policy status and premium payment before any further processing.

1.3 If the policy has lapsed on the date of loss, the claim must be declined and the claimant informed in writing.

2. Assessment

2.1 Claims above 10000 must be referred to a senior adjuster for approval.

2.2 Claims above 50000 require approval from the claims manager and a loss-adjuster assessment.

2.3 A site inspection must be completed within 5 working days of assignment for all property claims.

2.4 If fraud is suspected, the handler must escalate the claim to the Special Investigations Unit and must not communicate a decision to the claimant.

3. Payment

3.1 Payment must not be released until all required approvals are recorded in the claim file.

3.2 Approved payments shall be released within 7 days of final approval.

3.3 The handler may grant an interim payment of up to 30% of the estimated loss where the claim is undisputed.

4. Closure

4.1 A claim file shall be closed within 14 days after the final payment is confirmed.

4.2 The claimant is entitled to a written explanation within 5 days of any rejection.